

Handoff: ArtHound Design System & Studio App UI

Overview

ArtHound is a canonical production data layer for game studios — it ingests messy asset, review, and workflow data from existing tools (PLM, file shares, review boards) and presents one clean, dark-themed control surface for studio leads, producers, and outsourcing managers.

This handoff covers the **studio-facing web app** (the dark, lavender-accented React UI) plus the design tokens that govern it. The vendor-facing app and the Cu-TOOL-u bot panel are referenced but **not yet designed** — see "Out of scope" below.

About the design files

The files in this bundle are **design references created in HTML/JSX** — prototypes that show intended look and behavior. They are **not production code to copy directly**.

- The **JSX in `ui_kit/`** is plain Babel-in-the-browser JSX wired to an inline HTML harness. It demonstrates structure, copy, and styling — it does not use React Router, real auth, or real data fetching.
- The **HTML in `preview/`** is a flat catalog of swatches and component cards used to visualize the design system.

The implementation task is to **recreate these designs inside the existing ArtHound codebase** (Vite + React 18 + React Router + Tailwind v4 with `@theme` custom properties + sonner toasts) using its established patterns. The repo already has `frontend/src/index.css` defining most of the same tokens under Tailwind's `@theme`; the goal is parity, not a rewrite.

Fidelity

High-fidelity. Colors, typography, spacing, radii, shadows, and component chrome are final. Implementers should match values pixel-for-pixel using the codebase's existing Tailwind theme + `cn()` helper. Copy text in the prototypes is intentional and should be preserved unless product asks otherwise.

Typography is now Geist. Both the prototypes and the production app should use Geist (loaded from Google Fonts) with `system-ui` as the fallback. This replaces the earlier Inter substitution. Geist's tightened tracking (`letter-spacing: -0.005em` on body / nav) is intentional — keep it.

Files in this bundle

```
design_handoff_arthound/
├── README.md                                ← you are here
├── tokens/
│   └── colors_and_type.css                 ← canonical CSS custom properties
├── ui_kit/
│   ├── index.html                         ← harness; open this to view all screens
│   ├── kit.css                           ← shared utility classes
│   ├── Components.jsx                    ← Topbar, Button, Pill, Avatar, etc.
│   ├── Login.jsx
│   ├── StudioHome.jsx
│   ├── AssetsScreen.jsx
│   └── NewReviewModal.jsx
├── preview/                               ← design-system catalog (open _card.css consumers individ
│   ├── colors-brand.html, colors-surface.html, colors-fg.html,
│   │   colors-status.html, colors-priority.html
│   ├── type-scale.html, type-specimen.html
│   ├── spacing-radii.html, shadow-elevation.html
│   ├── components-buttons.html, components-inputs.html, components-pills.html,
│   │   components-cards.html, components-topbar.html, components-modal.html
│   └── brand-logo.html, brand-cutoolu.html
├── assets/
│   ├── ArtHound_logo.png                 ← latest hand-drawn ArtHound mark (authoritative)
│   ├── ArtHound_wordmark.png             ← lockup with tagline
│   ├── cutoolu_logo.png                  ← latest Cu-T00L-u mark (Cu-T00L-u panel only)
│   ├── cutoolu_wordmark.png
│   ├── favicon.svg                      ← saturated violet+cyan, ceremonial only
│   ├── icons.svg                        ← brand icon symbols (bluesky, etc.)
│   └── hero.png                          ← marketing splash
```

Design tokens

All tokens live in `tokens/colors_and_type.css` as CSS custom properties under the `--ah-*` prefix, and are mirrored in the production `frontend/src/index.css` under Tailwind v4 `@theme`. Use the existing Tailwind names (`bg-surface`, `text-fg-muted`, `border-border`, etc.) — do not introduce parallel utility classes.

Colors — brand

Token	Hex	Use
<code>--ah-brand-purple</code> / <code>--ah-accent</code>	<code>#7c6af4</code>	Primary actions, links, focus ring
<code>--ah-brand-purple-soft</code> / <code>--ah-fg-link</code>	<code>#b6a8ff</code>	Logo outline tint, link hover
<code>--ah-brand-purple-deep</code>	<code>#4d3ad6</code>	Pressed states
<code>--ah-accent-hover</code>	<code>#9b8ef8</code>	Button hover
<code>--ah-accent-tint</code>	<code>rgba(124, 106, 244, 0.10)</code>	Selected row, focus background
<code>--ah-brand-violet-glow</code>	<code>#863bff</code>	Favicon only
<code>--ah-brand-violet-deep</code>	<code>#7e14ff</code>	Favicon only
<code>--ah-brand-cyan-spark</code>	<code>#47bfff</code>	Favicon accent only — never in chrome

Colors — surfaces (dark, near-black with violet hue)

Token	Hex	Use
<code>--ah-bg</code>	<code>#0d0a1a</code>	Page background
<code>--ah-surface</code>	<code>#161229</code>	Cards, top bar, modals
<code>--ah-surface-2</code>	<code>#1f1a3a</code>	Inputs, hover row, sidebar selected
<code>--ah-surface-3</code>	<code>#2a2350</code>	Secondary buttons, deepest chip
<code>--ah-overlay</code>	<code>rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.60)</code>	Modal scrim
<code>--ah-border</code>	<code>#3a2f6b</code>	Default 1px borders
<code>--ah-border-soft</code>	<code>#2a2350</code>	Table row dividers

Colors — foreground

Token	Hex	Use
<code>--ah-fg</code>	<code>#ece6ff</code>	Primary text (off-white lavender)
<code>--ah-fg-muted</code>	<code>#a89cd6</code>	Labels, captions, secondary
<code>--ah-fg-disabled</code>	<code>#6b62a3</code>	Disabled
<code>--ah-fg-on-accent</code>	<code>#ffffff</code>	Text on accent fill

Colors — status

Token	Hex	Tint
<code>--ah-success</code>	<code>#34d399</code>	<code>rgba(52,211,153,0.12)</code>
<code>--ah-info</code>	<code>#60a5fa</code>	<code>rgba(96,165,250,0.12)</code>
<code>--ah-warning</code>	<code>#fbbf24</code>	<code>rgba(251,191,36,0.12)</code>
<code>--ah-error</code>	<code>#f87171</code>	<code>rgba(248,113,113,0.12)</code>

Colors — priority scale

P1 `#34d399` (highest) → P2 `#60a5fa` → P3 `#fbbf24` → P4 `#f97316` → P5 `#f87171` (lowest). Use as backgrounds with white text for priority chips.

Type

- **Family:** "Geist", system-ui, -apple-system, "Segoe UI", Roboto, sans-serif . Load Geist from Google Fonts (weights 400/500/600/700). Apply letter-spacing: `-0.005em` to body, nav, and button text; `-0.01em` on display headings.
- **Mono:** "JetBrains Mono", ui-monospace, "SF Mono", Menlo, monospace for asset IDs, version numbers, and any tabular data.
- **Scale:** 10 / 12 / 14 / 16 / 18 / 20 / 24 / 30 px. The app is data-heavy — default body is **14px**, table cells and chips **12px**, page titles **18px**, hero/welcome **24px**.
- **Weights:** 400 regular, 500 medium, 600 semibold, 700 bold.
- **Tracking:** `-0.01em` on display headings, `0.04em` (uppercase) on eyebrows and the wordmark.

Spacing scale

`0 / 4 / 8 / 12 / 16 / 20 / 24 / 32 / 40 / 48 px` . Card padding is typically 24px; row gutters 12–16px; chip padding `2px 8–10px` .

Radii

`4 / 6 / 8 / 12 / 16px / pill` . Buttons **6px**, inputs and small cards **8px**, primary cards and modals **12px**, chips/pills are full-pill.

Elevation

Token	Value	Use
<code>--ah-shadow-sm</code>	<code>0 1px 2px rgba(0,0,0,0.30)</code>	Resting cards
<code>--ah-shadow-md</code>	<code>0 4px 14px rgba(0,0,0,0.35)</code>	Hovered cards, dropdowns
<code>--ah-shadow-lg</code>	<code>0 24px 48px -12px rgba(0,0,0,0.55)</code>	Modals
<code>--ah-shadow-glow</code>	accent ring + 8/24 shadow	Featured/active elements
<code>--ah-ring-focus</code>	<code>0 0 0 2px rgba(124,106,244,0.55)</code>	Keyboard focus

Motion

- Fast: **120ms** (button color/border changes)
- Normal: **180ms** (panel/modal open/close)
- Slow: **300ms** (page-level transitions)
- Easing: `cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)` for standard, `cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1.1)` for emphasized.

Screens

1. Login

Purpose: Studio members sign in with email + password. The page also displays the ArtHound brand at low opacity behind the form for atmosphere.

Layout: Single full-bleed centered column. Page bg `--ah-bg`. The logo backdrop is `ArtHound_logo.png` rendered at ~360px square, **10% opacity**, centered behind the form, `pointer-events:none`.

Form card: - 360px wide, padding 32px, radius 12px, bg `--ah-surface`, border `--ah-border`. - Title "Sign in to ArtHound" — 18px / 600. - Two inputs (email, password). Input chrome: bg `--ah-surface-2`, 1px `--ah-border`, radius 8px, padding `8px 12px`, font 14px. Focus → border `--ah-accent`, ring `--ah-ring-focus`. - Primary submit button full-width: bg `--ah-accent`, white text, height 36px, radius 6px, font 14px / 500. Hover → `--ah-accent-hover`. Loading state shows a small spinner in place of the label. - Below form: small muted helper "Trouble signing in? Contact your studio admin." in `--ah-fg-muted` 12px.

Behavior: On submit, `apiFetch('/auth/login', { POST email, password })`, then redirect to `/home`. On error, render `--ah-error` text under the form ("Invalid credentials") and reset the password field.

2. Studio Home

Purpose: Logged-in landing. Shows a personal greeting, a snapshot of in-flight production work, and quick links into the four product areas.

Layout: - **Topbar** (see component spec). - **Body:** centered max-width 1120px, padding 32px 24px, gap 32px column. - Hero row: 112px circular avatar (the ArtHound logo at full opacity, on `--ah-surface-2`) + "Welcome back, {name}" 24px / 600 + studio name muted 14px. - Quick-link grid: 4 cards in a 4-column grid (collapse to 2 cols below 900px). Each card: bg `--ah-surface`, border `--ah-border`, radius 12px, padding 24px, hover → border `--ah-border-on-accent`. Inside: 32px icon top-left, title 16px / 600, one-line muted description 12px. Cards: **Assets**, **Reviews**, **Workflows**, **Estimates**. - Below grid: "Activity" panel — bg `--ah-surface`, border, radius 12px, padding 16px. Lists last 5 events as rows: priority chip + asset id (mono 12px) + event text + relative timestamp (`a89cd6`).

3. Assets

Purpose: Browse, filter, and inspect the studio's catalog of assets (characters, environments, props). Three-pane layout.

Layout: - **Topbar** at top. - Below topbar, full-bleed three-pane row, each pane vertically scrolls: - **Left sidebar (240px):** Product groups. Each row is a button: padding 6px 12px, radius 6px, font 12px / 500. Inactive → `--ah-fg-muted`. Hover → bg `--ah-surface-2`, color `--ah-fg`. Active → bg `--ah-surface-2`, color `--ah-fg`, plus 2px left accent bar in `--ah-accent`. A pinned "All assets" row sits at the top; below it, products grouped under a small eyebrow label "Products" (uppercase 10px, tracking 0.04em, color `--ah-fg-muted`, padding 12px 12px 4px). Each product row may show a trailing count chip (the `.chip` style: bg `--ah-surface-2`, 12px). - **Center grid (flex 1):** A header row with: search input (`<input class="input" placeholder="Search assets...">`, max-width 320px), then chip filters (Type, Status, Owner, Priority — each a pill chip with a chevron). Below: responsive CSS grid `repeat(auto-fill, minmax(200px, 1fr))` gap 16px, padding 24px. Each tile: bg `--ah-surface`, radius 12px, border `--ah-border`, hover → border `--ah-border-on-accent`. Tile content: square thumbnail top (object-fit cover, radius 12px 12px 0 0), then padding 12px column with: asset name (14px / 500), asset id (mono 12px, `--ah-fg-muted`), and a row of: status pill + priority chip + version chip. - **Right detail panel (360px, conditional on selection):** Asset metadata. Header section padding 24px: large thumbnail (full width, radius 8px), asset name 18px / 600, id mono 12px muted, then a vertical key/value list (Owner, Status, Priority, Last review, Versions) — labels 12px muted, values 14px. Below: action row with `Open in Reviews` (primary) and `Edit` (secondary). Below that: a **Linked workflows** list (rows of workflow name + state pill).

Behavior: - Sidebar selection filters the grid; selected sidebar item gets the active styles. The chip filters open multi-select dropdowns. - Tile click → fills the right panel; double-click → opens the asset's Reviews. - Search debounces 200ms and queries `/assets?q= ...`. - Top-right of the center pane has a "+ New Review" button (primary) that opens the New Review modal (see below) with the selected asset pre-filled.

4. New Review Modal

Purpose: Create a review thread on an asset. Triggered from the Assets page or directly from an asset card.

Layout: Centered modal over `--ah-overlay` scrim. Modal: 480px wide, bg `--ah-surface`, radius 12px, border `--ah-border`, shadow `--ah-shadow-lg`, padding 24px. Sections stacked with 16px gap: -

Header: "New Review" 18px / 600 + close icon-button (ghost) right-aligned. - Asset row: read-only chip showing the selected asset's thumbnail + name + id. - Title input (single-line, full-width). - Description textarea (4 rows, full-width, same input chrome, resize vertical). - Reviewer multi-select: chip-style picker, each selected reviewer rendered as an accent chip with an `x` button. Below the input, a typeahead suggests studio members. - Priority radio: 5 segmented buttons P1–P5, each a `pill` styled with the matching `--ah-pN` background. - Footer: ghost "Cancel" (left) + primary "Create review" (right). Cancel closes the modal; Create posts to `/reviews` and routes to the new review's detail page.

Component specs

Topbar (`ui_kit/Components.jsx`)

- 56px tall, bg `--ah-surface` , 1px bottom border `--ah-border` , padding-x 16px.
- Left cluster: 24px logo (ArtHound_logo.png) + wordmark "ArtHound" 16px / 600
- 16px gap + nav links: **Home / Assets / Reviews / Workflows / Estimates**. Each is a NavLink: padding: 6px 12px , radius 6px, font 12px / 500, color `--ah-fg-muted` . Hover → bg `--ah-surface-2` , color `--ah-fg` . Active → bg `--ah-surface-2` , color `--ah-fg` (no underline).
- Right cluster: search icon button (ghost) + notifications icon button with unread dot in `--ah-accent` (4px circle, top-right of icon) + 32px circular avatar. Avatar click opens user menu (dropdown card on `--ah-surface-2` , radius 8px, shadow-md).

Buttons

Variant	Bg	Text	Hover
Primary	<code>--ah-accent</code>	<code>#fff</code>	<code>--ah-accent-hover</code>
Secondary	<code>--ah-surface-2</code>	<code>--ah-fg</code>	<code>--ah-surface-3</code>
Ghost	transparent	<code>--ah-fg-muted</code>	bg <code>--ah-surface-2</code> , color <code>--ah-fg</code>
Danger	<code>--ah-error</code>	<code>#fff</code>	(darken 8%)

All: 6px radius, 12px font / 500, padding `6px 12px` , gap `6px` for inline icons, `transition: background-color 120ms` . Disabled → 50% opacity, `cursor: not-allowed` . Focus → `--ah-ring-focus` .

Inputs

bg `--ah-surface-2` , 1px `--ah-border` , radius 8px, padding `8px 12px` , font 14px, color `--ah-fg` . Placeholder `--ah-fg-disabled` . Focus → border `--ah-accent` , `box-shadow: var(--ah-ring-focus)` .

Pills (status & priority)

Pill base: padding `3px 10px` , radius pill, font 12px / 500, inline-flex. - `pill-success` / `pill-info` / `pill-warning` / `pill-error` use the matching status tint as bg and the full saturation color as text. - Priority pills (P1–P5) use the priority hex as bg with white text.

Chip

Base: `bg --ah-surface-2`, color `--ah-fg-muted`, padding `2px 8px`, radius pill, 12px. `chip--accent` variant is transparent with a 1px `--ah-accent` border and accent-colored text — used for tag chips and selected-filter chips.

Card

`bg --ah-surface`, 1px `--ah-border`, radius 12px. Interactive variant (`.card-int`) gets `border-color --ah-border-on-accent` on hover with a 120ms transition. Padding is contextual (16px for compact panels, 24px for primary content).

Interactions & behavior

- **Page transitions:** none — these are router-level swaps with no animation.
- **Modal open:** scrim fades 180ms, modal scales from 96% with 180ms emphasized easing.
- **Toasts (sonner):** anchor bottom-right; default style overrides should use `--ah-surface-2` `bg`, `--ah-fg` text, 1px `--ah-border`, radius 8px, shadow-md.
- **Loading rows / cards:** use the `.skeleton` class — `--ah-surface-2` background pulsing 0.5↔1 opacity over 1.4s.
- **Empty states:** centered column. Logo at 96px, 30% opacity. Title 16px / 500 `--ah-fg`. Subtitle 12px `--ah-fg-muted`. Optional primary action button.
- **Keyboard:** all interactive elements receive `--ah-ring-focus` on `:focus-visible`. The asset grid supports arrow-key navigation; `Enter` selects, `Space` opens detail.

State management

Existing app already uses React Router + `apiFetch` (a thin wrapper over `fetch` with auth headers) + `sonner`. Continue those. The screens here introduce nothing new — selection state on Assets is local component state; no global store is required.

Out of scope for this handoff

- **Reviews list & review detail page** — has been started in the live app (`frontend/src/pages/Reviews.jsx`); design has not yet been refreshed.
- **Workflows page** — design unchanged from the existing `Workflows.jsx`.
- **Estimates page** — design has not yet been started.
- **Vendor app** — separate codebase / surface; not designed yet.
- **Cu-TOOL-u bot panel (NumberBot, LoreBot)** — only the brand mark is designed; the conversation surface has not been spec'd.
- **Filter dropdown internals** on the Assets page — visual chip is designed; the dropdown body is not.

Assets — provenance

- `ArtHound_logo.png` / `ArtHound_wordmark.png` — supplied by client; treat as authoritative. The PNG in this bundle is the **latest** version — replace any older mark in `frontend/public/` with this file.
- `cutoolu_logo.png` / `cutoolu_wordmark.png` — supplied by client; **only** used in the Cu-TOOL-u panel. The PNG in this bundle is the **latest** version — replace any older mark in `frontend/public/` with this file.
- `favicon.svg` — supplied; saturated violet+cyan gradient. Use only as the browser favicon — the saturation is too hot for in-app chrome.
- `icons.svg` — symbol sprite (Bluesky etc.) shipped from the existing repo.
- `hero.png` — marketing splash; not used in app chrome.

How to view the prototypes

1. Open `ui_kit/index.html` in a browser to see Login → Studio Home → Assets → New Review wired together.
2. Open any file in `preview/` directly to inspect a single token group or component card.

The prototypes load Inter from Google Fonts, React 18 + Babel from unpkg. They run with no build step.